

Auxiliary verbs

SOME VERBS HELP TO FORM OTHER VERBS.

Often called “helping verbs,” auxiliary verbs can be used in front of other verbs to form tenses, negative sentences, and the passive voice, or to express different moods.

SEE ALSO

◀ 34–35	Pronouns
◀ 38–39	Verbs
◀ 42–43	Simple tenses
◀ 44–45	Perfect and continuous tenses
◀ 46–47	Participles
Voices and moods	54–55 ▶
Negatives	80–81 ▶
Question marks	110–111 ▶

Helpful properties

Auxiliary verbs are known as helping verbs because they perform several different roles. Their main job is to help form different tenses, but they are also used to create negative sentences, turn statements into questions, and add emphasis to speech.

Must is the **only verb** in English to have a **present** but **no past** form.

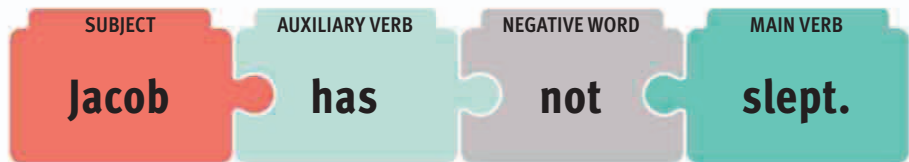
▷ Forming tenses

Auxiliary verbs are used to link the main verb to the subject, helping to form different tenses. The future, perfect, and continuous tenses all rely on auxiliary verbs.



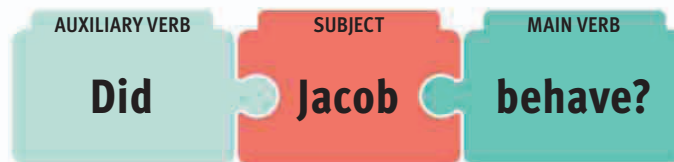
▷ Forming negatives

Auxiliary verbs are the only verbs that can be made negative. A negative sentence is formed by placing the word *not* between the auxiliary verb and the main verb.



▷ Forming questions

In a statement, the subject always comes before the verb. Auxiliary verbs can switch places with their subjects in order to form questions.



▷ Adding emphasis

Auxiliary verbs can also be used for emphasis, particularly when the speaker wants to contradict a previous statement.

